FREE RECIPE GUIDE

30 High-Protein Recipes for Muscle Gain

Every Recipe Over 40g Protein Per Serving

For Fitness Professionals & Their Clients

EvoFitMeals

evofitmeals.com

Protein & Muscle Growth

The science-backed fundamentals every trainer should know when programming nutrition for hypertrophy clients.

How Much Protein Do You Actually Need?

Research consistently supports **1.6–2.2 g of protein per kilogram of body weight** per day for maximizing muscle protein synthesis. For a 180 lb (82 kg) individual, that translates to roughly **130–180 g of protein daily**. Going above 2.2 g/kg shows diminishing returns for muscle growth, though it won't cause harm in healthy individuals.

- Beginners & moderate lifters: aim for 1.6 g/kg
- Advanced lifters in a caloric surplus: 1.8–2.0 g/kg
- Lifters in a caloric deficit (cutting): push to 2.2 g/kg to preserve lean mass

The Post-Workout Window: Myth Debunked

The "anabolic window" — the idea that you must consume protein within 30 minutes of training — has been largely **debunked by modern research**. A 2013 meta-analysis by Schoenfeld et al. found that **total daily protein intake matters far more than timing**. The real window is roughly 4–6 hours around your workout (before and after combined).

- Eat a protein-rich meal 2–3 hours before training
- Follow up within 2–3 hours post-workout — no rush needed
- Spread protein across 3–5 meals for optimal MPS signaling
- Aim for at least 0.4 g/kg per meal (roughly 30–40 g per sitting)

Complete vs. Incomplete Proteins

Complete proteins contain all 9 essential amino acids in sufficient quantities. Animal sources (chicken, beef, fish, eggs, dairy) are inherently complete. Most plant sources are **incomplete** on their own but can be combined for a full amino acid profile.

- **Complete:** Chicken, beef, fish, eggs, dairy, soy, quinoa
- **Incomplete (combine them):** Rice + beans, peanut butter + whole wheat, lentils + grains
- Leucine is the key trigger for MPS — aim for 2.5–3 g per meal
- Whey protein has the highest leucine content (~11%) of any source

Breakfast Recipes

MORNING FUEL • 8 RECIPES

Protein Banana Pancakes
48g P | 420 cal

Blend oats, egg whites, banana, and whey protein into a thick batter. Cook on a non-stick pan until golden. Top with Greek yogurt and berries for extra protein.

Loaded Egg White Omelette
44g P | 310 cal

8 egg whites folded with turkey breast, spinach, bell peppers, and a sprinkle of feta cheese. A classic high-volume, low-calorie breakfast staple.

Greek Yogurt Power Bowl
42g P | 380 cal

Thick Greek yogurt layered with whey protein granola, sliced almonds, chia seeds, and mixed berries. High in casein for sustained amino acid release.

Overnight Protein Oats
45g P | 440 cal

Rolled oats soaked overnight in milk with a scoop of whey protein, peanut butter, and flaxseed. Grab-and-go meal prep that's ready in the morning.

Steak & Eggs Classic
56g P | 480 cal

5 oz sirloin steak seared medium-rare alongside 3 whole eggs scrambled with chives. Pair with roasted sweet potato for complex carbs.

Cottage Cheese Waffles
41g P | 350 cal

Blend cottage cheese, oats, eggs, and vanilla in a waffle maker. The cottage cheese creates a fluffy, protein-dense texture with zero protein powder needed.

Smoked Salmon Toast
40g P | 390 cal

Whole grain toast layered with cream cheese, 4 oz smoked salmon, capers, red onion, and a poached egg. Rich in omega-3s and complete protein.

Breakfast Burrito Bowl
52g P | 460 cal

Scrambled eggs with chicken sausage, black beans, salsa, and avocado over brown rice. A savory powerhouse that covers all your macros in one bowl.

Lunch Recipes

🏋 MIDDAY MUSCLE • 8 RECIPES

Grilled Chicken Caesar Wrap

50g P | 450 cal

6 oz grilled chicken breast, romaine, shaved parmesan, and light Caesar dressing in a whole wheat tortilla. Meal-prep friendly and travels well.

Tuna Quinoa Power Bowl

48g P | 410 cal

Seared ahi tuna over tri-color quinoa with edamame, cucumber, avocado, and a sesame-ginger drizzle. Two complete protein sources in one bowl.

Turkey Meatball Sub

46g P | 470 cal

Lean ground turkey meatballs baked with marinara and melted mozzarella on a whole grain hoagie. Half the fat of traditional meatball subs with all the flavor.

Garlic Shrimp Stir-Fry

44g P | 380 cal

8 oz shrimp sauteed with garlic, broccoli, snap peas, and bell peppers in a light soy-ginger sauce over jasmine rice. Quick 15-minute cook time.

Black Bean Chicken Bowl

52g P | 490 cal

Seasoned grilled chicken over cilantro-lime rice with black beans, corn salsa, and a dollop of Greek yogurt. A Chipotle-style bowl with cleaner macros.

Mediterranean Lentil Salad

41g P | 400 cal

Green lentils with grilled halloumi, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red onion, and lemon-herb dressing. A plant-forward option with 41g complete protein.

Thai Peanut Chicken Lettuce Wraps

45g P | 360 cal

Shredded rotisserie chicken tossed in peanut sauce with shredded carrots and cilantro, served in butter lettuce cups. Low-carb and incredibly satisfying.

Salmon Avocado Poke Bowl

43g P | 480 cal

Cubed fresh salmon marinated in soy and sesame over sushi rice with avocado, mango, edamame, and crispy seaweed. Omega-3 rich and refeed-day perfect.

Dinner Recipes

🌙 EVENING RECOVERY • 8 RECIPES

Herb-Crusted Grilled Salmon
46g P | 440 cal

8 oz Atlantic salmon fillet crusted with Dijon, garlic, and fresh dill, served with roasted asparagus and quinoa. Rich in omega-3s for recovery and inflammation control.

Lean Beef & Broccoli Stir-Fry
50g P | 460 cal

Thinly sliced flank steak wok-seared with broccoli florets in a low-sodium oyster sauce. Served over brown rice. Iron and zinc for testosterone support.

Healthy Chicken Parmesan
54g P | 490 cal

Air-fried chicken breast with whole wheat panko, marinara, and part-skim mozzarella. Served over zucchini noodles. All the comfort, half the calories of the original.

Lemon Herb Baked Cod
42g P | 320 cal

Fresh cod fillets baked with lemon, garlic, and fresh herbs. Paired with roasted sweet potatoes and green beans. Ultra-lean with virtually zero fat.

Ground Turkey Stuffed Peppers
44g P | 410 cal

Bell peppers filled with seasoned lean ground turkey, brown rice, black beans, and topped with melted cheddar. Two peppers per serving for serious volume eating.

Bison Burger Lettuce Wrap
48g P | 390 cal

6 oz bison patty with caramelized onions, tomato, and avocado in crisp iceberg lettuce. Bison is leaner than beef with higher iron and B12 content.

Teriyaki Chicken Thigh Bowl
47g P | 470 cal

Boneless chicken thighs glazed with homemade low-sugar teriyaki, served over sticky rice with steamed bok choy and sesame seeds. Client favorite.

Garlic Butter Shrimp Pasta
43g P | 450 cal

Jumbo shrimp sauteed in garlic and light butter sauce tossed with high-protein chickpea pasta, cherry tomatoes, and fresh basil. Refeed-night worthy.

Snack Recipes

QUICK FUEL • 6 RECIPES

Chocolate Peanut Butter Protein Balls

42g P | 350 cal

Roll together whey protein, peanut butter, oats, dark chocolate chips, and honey into bite-sized balls. Makes 4 balls per serving. Perfect grab-and-go between clients or sessions.

Savory Cottage Cheese Bowl

40g P | 280 cal

1.5 cups of cottage cheese topped with everything bagel seasoning, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, and a drizzle of olive oil. Casein-rich for slow-digesting protein between meals.

Jerky & Nut Trail Mix

41g P | 390 cal

Beef jerky pieces mixed with roasted almonds, pumpkin seeds, dark chocolate chips, and dried cranberries. Pack in ziplock bags for a week of high-protein snacking.

Spicy Edamame Crunch

40g P | 340 cal

Shelled edamame tossed with chili flakes, garlic powder, sesame oil, and sea salt, then air-fried until crispy. A crunchy, plant-based protein bomb with complete aminos from soy.

Tuna-Stuffed Avocado

44g P | 370 cal

Halved avocado filled with seasoned tuna salad made with Greek yogurt instead of mayo, lemon zest, and diced celery. Healthy fats plus lean protein in every bite.

Protein Cookie Dough Dip

40g P | 310 cal

Blend chickpeas, vanilla whey, peanut butter, maple syrup, and mini chocolate chips. Serve with apple slices or rice cakes. Tastes like dessert, hits like a protein shake.

💡 Snacking Strategy for Muscle Gain

Space snacks **3–4 hours apart** from main meals to maintain elevated muscle protein synthesis throughout the day. Each snack should deliver at least **30–40g protein** to hit the leucine threshold needed to trigger MPS. Prep snacks in bulk on Sundays — clients who meal-prep snacks are 3x more likely to hit their daily protein targets.

The Protein Cheat Sheet

Quick reference: protein content per 100g for the 20 most common muscle-building foods. Print this page and pin it to your fridge.

FOOD	PROTEIN PER 100G
	POULTRY & MEAT
Chicken Breast (cooked)	31g
Turkey Breast (cooked)	29g
Lean Ground Beef (95/5)	26g
Bison / Buffalo	28g
Pork Tenderloin	26g
	FISH & SEAFOOD
Tuna (canned in water)	26g
Salmon (Atlantic, cooked)	25g
Shrimp (cooked)	24g
Cod (cooked)	23g
	DAIRY & EGGS
Greek Yogurt (non-fat)	10g
Cottage Cheese (low-fat)	11g
Whole Eggs	13g
Egg Whites	11g
Whey Protein Powder	80g
	PLANT-BASED
Tofu (firm)	17g
Tempeh	19g
Lentils (cooked)	9g
Chickpeas (cooked)	9g
Edamame (shelled)	11g
Quinoa (cooked)	4g

Pro Tip: Lean Sources

Chicken breast, turkey, cod, and egg whites give you the most protein per calorie. Use these when cutting to maximize protein while staying in a deficit.

Pro Tip: Bulking Sources

Salmon, whole eggs, and bison offer protein plus healthy fats and micronutrients. Use these when in a surplus and calories are less restricted.

Generate Unlimited High-Protein Meal Plans with AI

Stop spending hours building meal plans manually. EvoFitMeals creates personalized, macro-perfect plans for every client in seconds.

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Get Started

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- ✓ Advanced dietary filters

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- ✓ White-label branding
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- ✓ Dedicated account manager

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What trainers are saying: "I used to spend 2 hours per client on meal plans. Now it takes 30 seconds. My clients love the variety and I've doubled my roster."

— Sarah K., Certified Personal Trainer

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AI-powered meal planning for fitness professionals

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